Groww for GenZ — Build Prompts

9 October 2026 · **Apoorva Pandey**

How this was built

The prototype is one self-contained HTML file, built with Claude (Claude Opus 5.5 on claude.ai) and published as a Claude artifact. It followed a spec-first loop: brief, spec, build, evals, fix.

1. Prompt 0 gave Claude the case-study PDF with a one-line ask.
2. Claude expanded it into Prompts 1–8: a product spec, a design system and one prompt per feature layer.
3. The app was built layer by layer, in prompt order.
4. Prompt 9 defined an automated eval harness that runs the real app in a headless DOM.
5. Failing checks went back through the fix-loop prompt until the suite passed.

Prompts 1–9 were generated by Claude from Prompt 0 and are reproduced as executed.

Prompt 0 — kickoff brief

Sent with the attachment `Groww_Product_Intern_-_Case_study.pdf`, verbatim:

```
I have been given this assignment/task to be submitted, please do the required work and give all
deliverables, make sure its your best work.
you have to be on God Mode
/God_Mode
```

Prompt 1 — product spec

This prompt fixes the user, the problem, the principles, the scope and testable acceptance criteria. Every later prompt inherits it.

```
Role: You are a senior product designer and front-end engineer on Groww's new-investor team.

Task: Build a working, clickable mobile prototype called "Groww for GenZ" as ONE self-contained
HTML file. Work in layers. This prompt is the spec every later prompt must respect.

Users: Indians aged 20–26 opening their first investment account.
- Students: pocket money, tuition gigs, stipends; ₹100–₹5,000 a month to invest.
- First-jobbers: monthly salary ₹25k–1L+; rent, EMIs, lifestyle creep.
- Freelancers and part-timers: income arrives in waves.

Problem: For a 22-year-old, three things decide outcomes: starting at all, staying consistent
through dips, and avoiding big avoidable losses. Broking apps optimise for activity, not those
three. Design for start, stay and safe.

Evidence to design around:
- SEBI study (FY26, published Aug 2026): about 88.5% of F&O traders under 30 lost money; under-
30s are 43% of individual F&O traders.
- AMFI: the SIP stoppage ratio crossed 100% in March–April 2026, during a volatile market.
- Checking a portfolio daily makes normal volatility feel like loss (myopic loss aversion).

Product principles:
```

```
1. Goals before numbers: lead with what the money is for; totals are secondary.
2. Range, not promise: every projection shows many simulated futures, the bad-luck case and the
chance of ending below what you put in.
3. Calm by default: daily moves hidden unless asked for; dips explained, never hidden.
4. Learn in the flow: every jargon word is tappable; lessons are 60-second stories.
5. Guardrails, not walls: risky products need a Learner's License; pausing a SIP is always
allowed, after one honest screen.
6. Social without amounts: friends see progress % and streaks, never rupees; rank by
consistency, never returns.

In scope: 4-step onboarding -> starter plan -> UPI Autopay mock -> Home -> goal detail with
futures chart -> Explore (plain-language categories, fund detail, Future simulator) -> Learn
(bytes, jargon decoder, Hinglish) -> payday autopilot, round-ups, streaks, calm view, dip mode -
> Learner's License for F&O -> Tip Check -> Squad -> Profile. A demo panel lets reviewers
trigger payday, a market dip, a 6-month fast-forward and a reset.

Out of scope: KYC and account opening, real market data, real payments, stock and F&O order
screens, tax filing, credit, back end, push notifications.

Assumptions (state them in the UI where relevant):
- Funds, NAVs and returns are illustrative; fund houses are fictional.
- Payday detection would use Groww UPI or Account Aggregator consent.
- Return model: Safe 6.5%/yr (sigma 1%), Balanced 8.5% (sigma 7%), Growth 11% (sigma 16%).

Acceptance criteria:
- One HTML file under 300 KB; only Google Fonts loads from the network; no console errors.
- Every projection shows a downside case and an "illustrative, not guaranteed" note.
- No "guaranteed returns", "risk-free" or "sure shot" outside quoted scam examples.
- F&O never appears in an onboarding plan; every fund screen shows riskometer level and expense
ratio.
- Text contrast >= 4.5:1 in light and dark themes; tap targets >= 44 px; reduced motion
respected.
```

Evidence sources: SEBI FY26 F&O study (IANS, 20 Aug 2026), AMFI SIP stoppage ratio, Mar–Apr 2026 (Angel One).

Prompt 2 — design system

This prompt keeps the app recognisably Groww while giving it a younger voice, and bans the generic AI-fintech look.

```
Design system for Groww for GenZ. Stay recognisably Groww (mint, clean, friendly) with a younger
voice.
Avoid generic AI-fintech looks: no near-black page with one neon accent, no identical rounded
cards with the same grey shadow, no all-caps eyebrow labels, no "A · B · C" meta strings, no
arrows appended to button text.

Palette (light / dark):
- Groww mint #00D09C: brand fills and primary buttons; text on it #04281D
- Lagoon ink #102A33: primary text (dark theme: #E8F3F0 on #0B1A1F)
- Paper #F5F8F6: app background (dark #0B1A1F, surfaces #12262C)
- Sun #FFC53D: streaks and celebrations
- Lilac #6A4FF0: learning
- Coral #C93434: losses and warnings, used sparingly
Bucket colours: Safe = sky #2F7BEA, Balanced = amber #E59A00, Growth = mint.

Type: Anek Latin (Ek Type, variable width and weight) for headlines and numbers, set wide and
heavy. Mukta (Ek Type) for reading text. Both are Indian-foundry faces. Scale: 13, 15, 17, 21,
28, 36, 48 px. Tabular figures for money.
```

```
Layout: phone-first single column, left-aligned, 20 px side margins. Radius by hierarchy: sheets
28, cards 20, inputs 14, chips full pill. Separate sections with space and hairlines; use cards
only for things you can tap. On desktop, centre the phone and put a presenter panel with the
demo controls on the left.

Signature element: the futures chart. Draw 60 sampled paths as thin translucent strands, the
10th–90th percentile band and a bold median, so users literally see many possible futures. This
is the one bold thing; keep everything around it quiet.

Motion: only in answer to a tap (sheets, toggles, confetti on the first investment) plus one
reveal: the strands drawing in on the plan screen. Respect prefers-reduced-motion.

Voice: plain, warm, short, sentence case. Hinglish only where the user switches it on. Buttons
say exactly what happens ("Start my plan", "Invest ₹2,850").
```

Prompt 3 — app shell, onboarding and plan engine

The plan rules are written as numbers, not adjectives, so the eval harness can test them exactly.

```
Build the app shell, onboarding and plan engine.

Shell: vanilla JS, no framework. One state object, a render function per route, event delegation
through data-act attributes. Routes: welcome, onboarding (4 steps), plan, success, home, goal,
explore, category, fund, sim, learn, squad, profile, dip, license, tipcheck. Bottom tabs: Home,
Explore, Learn, Squad, You. Bottom sheets for every confirmation. Expose window.__app for tests;
window.__FAST = true removes all delays.

Onboarding (one screen per step, progress bar on top, back allowed):
1. Name (optional) + situation: Student / First job / Freelance or part-time.
2. Monthly money in (bands depend on situation) + "How much can you invest without stress?"
slider. Default = 10% of the band midpoint (15% for first job), in multiples of ₹50. Show "about
X% of what comes in" and a comfort label: <=15% Comfy, <=30% A stretch, <=45% Ambitious, >45%
Too tight, with a nudge to keep rent and food covered.
3. Goals (multi-select, at least one): Trip, Gadget, Emergency fund, Higher studies, Future me
(5+ years), Just exploring.
4. Vibe check: "You invest ₹10,000. A month later it shows ₹8,500. You'd…" Sell before it gets
worse / Wait it out / Invest a bit more.

Plan engine rules:
- Default goals: Trip ₹15,000 in 8 months; Gadget ₹45,000 in 12; Emergency = one month of
expenses (student ₹10,000; others 50% of income midpoint, rounded to ₹5,000) in 6 months; Higher
studies ₹2,00,000 in 36; Future me = long term, projected over 10 years; Just exploring = Future
me with a small amount.
- Bucket by horizon: emergency or <=12 months -> Safe (liquid fund); 13–48 -> Balanced (balanced
advantage fund); >48 -> Growth (Nifty 50 index fund). If the vibe answer is "sell", Future me
starts in Balanced, with a note saying so.
- Need per deadline goal = target / months, rounded up to ₹50.
- Reserve for Future me = max(₹100, 20% of the monthly amount).
- If needs fit, fund them fully and send the rest to Future me. If not, Emergency gets up to
half of what's left first; other goals share the rest in proportion to need, never above need.
- Every SIP is a multiple of ₹50 and at least ₹100, or zero. SIPs must sum exactly to the
monthly amount.
- Show each goal as on track (with date) or "at this pace" (later date). F&O is never part of a
plan.
- Any goal's target and months can be edited from the plan; the plan recomputes.

Plan screen: allocation strip, one row per goal (emoji, name, bucket chip, ₹/month, date
status), "Why this plan" in three plain reasons, the futures chart for the main goal, CTA "Start
```

```
with ₹X/month" -> UPI Autopay sheet (pause or cancel anytime) -> success with confetti: first
instalment today, next on the 5th.
```

Prompt 4 — home, goals and the futures chart

```
Build Home, goal detail and the futures chart.

Home (goals first): greeting; calm-view switch; goal rows with progress, bucket colour and
status; a smaller total ("Put in ₹X, worth ₹Y"); a monthly streak strip; contextual cards in
this order when relevant: dip, payday, round-ups, today's byte. Calm view is ON by default and
hides every daily change and the market ticker.

Goal detail: saved vs target with progress; why this bucket in two sentences; the fund (tap for
detail); SIP card (change amount, pause); futures chart for the remaining horizon; "Add money"
sheet.

Futures chart (the signature):
- Monte Carlo with a seeded RNG (mulberry32) so it is reproducible: 400 paths, monthly steps,
contribution at the start of each month, log-normal returns with the bucket's mu and sigma.
- Draw 60 paths as thin strands at low opacity, the 10th–90th percentile band, a bold median and
a dashed "money you put in" line.
- Under it: typical (median), bad luck (10th percentile), good luck (90th percentile) and the
chance of ending below what you put in.
- Label: "Simulation with assumed returns. Illustrative, not guaranteed."

Future simulator (Explore): sliders for ₹/month (₹100–₹20,000) and years (1–20) plus a Safe /
Balanced / Growth switch. The chart and the chance of loss update live, so users watch risk fall
as time rises.
```

Prompt 5 — habit and calm features

```
Add the habit and calm layer.

- Streak = consecutive months with any investment, never days, so the app never rewards daily
checking. Freelancers get two skip passes a year that don't break it.
- Payday autopilot: a demo trigger posts "₹X credited" (salary, stipend or client payment, by
situation). The sheet suggests investing 10% with a slider (0–50%), split across goals in
proportion to their SIPs; one tap invests. Real detection would use Groww UPI or Account
Aggregator consent.
- Round-ups: round each UPI payment up to the next ₹10 into a chosen goal; Home shows the week's
total with a "Sweep now" button.
- Calm view: hides daily moves; explains why the first time it is switched.
- Dip mode (demo trigger: market -4.1%): Home shows a calm card, never a red alarm. The dip
screen explains what happened, what it means per goal (Safe untouched, Growth dipped, years
left), a real history check (Nifty 50 fell about 40% from Jan to Mar 2020 and set a new high in
Nov 2020) and that the next SIP buys more units. Options: keep going (default), add a little
extra, pause.
- Pausing a SIP always works. First it shows one honest screen on what pausing in a dip costs,
then: Keep investing / Pause 1 month / Pause until I resume.
- Fast-forward 6 months (demo): adds six SIP instalments with a fixed sequence of monthly
returns per bucket and extends the streak.
```

History-check source: Nifty's 2020 fall and recovery (Angel One).

Prompt 6 — learning layer

```
Add the learning layer.

Bytes: seven 60-second lessons as tap-through stories (progress bars on top, tap right to advance, left to go back), 3–5 slides each and one quiz question with exactly one right answer and an explanation. Topics: SIPs, index funds, why your portfolio is red, emergency fund first, expense ratio (compute the 20-year cost of 0.2% vs 1.5% live), F&O reality check, spotting a scam tip. +20 XP for a correct answer, +10 for finishing either way; a new level every 60 XP.

Jargon decoder: every finance term in the UI is a dotted-underline button that opens a sheet with a plain definition, an everyday analogy and a Hinglish version. Terms: SIP, NAV, expense ratio, exit load, index fund, liquid fund, Nifty 50, volatility, compounding, rupee-cost averaging, direct plan, XIRR, F&O, leverage, diversification, lock-in, units, riskometer. A language switch sets English or Hinglish for every explanation.

Copy rules: sentences under 20 words, no undefined jargon, Flesch reading ease >= 50 for English text.
```

Prompt 7 — guardrails

```
Add guardrails.

Learner's License for F&O (Explore shows F&O as locked):
1. Reality check: SEBI's FY26 numbers in plain words.
2. Leverage lab: ₹5,000 in an index fund vs the same ₹5,000 as margin on 10x futures, over a random 5-day market path. Play three rounds. Futures can be wiped out.
3. Quiz: four questions, pass at 3 of 4, retry allowed.
4. Guardrails: a monthly loss limit (₹500–₹10,000), an acknowledgement, a 24-hour cooling-off and a note that income proof is needed next.
Steps unlock in order. Then status Cooling off (demo skip available) -> Active, with the loss limit shown. Students with under ₹5k a month see a "we'd suggest waiting" note but are never blocked.

Tip Check: paste any tip. A transparent rule-based scorer flags guaranteed returns, unrealistic gains, paid tip-group funnels, urgency, insider or operator claims, requests for money, penny stocks, FOMO, chasing recent gains and social-media hype; long-term language lowers the score. Score 0–100: Low <25, Medium 25–59, High >=60. Each flag explains itself in one line. Include three samples: a scam, a FOMO message from a friend, a sensible plan. Always end with: verify the registration on SEBI's website (investment advisers start with INA, research analysts with INH) and never pay for tips from unregistered sources. Escape all pasted text.
```

Prompt 8 — squad

```
Add Squad: social without amounts.

- A group goal ("Goa trip squad") where each friend saves in their own account. Show each member's progress as a percentage and their streak, never rupees.
- A consistency board ranked by streak, labelled "Ranked by consistency, never returns".
- Nudge a friend who hasn't invested this month (a toast confirms); share an invite link.
- After the first investment, a shareable milestone card that shows the milestone, never the amount.
```

Prompt 9 — eval harness and fix loop

```
Write an eval harness that loads the real HTML in jsdom (scripts enabled, window.__FAST = true)
and drives it through the UI the way a user would: clicking data-act buttons, typing, moving
sliders.

Report PASS/FAIL per check, grouped:
- Functional: every flow end to end, plan invariants (SIPs sum to the monthly amount, multiples
of ₹50, >= ₹100 or 0), back navigation, reset.
- Guardrails: banned phrases on every screen outside quoted scam examples; every projection
shows a downside and a disclaimer; F&O never in any plan across all situation x goal x vibe
combinations; every fund shows risk and expense ratio; pause always possible; no rupee amounts
on Squad; board sorted by streak.
- Personas: four scripted users (student saving for a trip; first-jobber with emergency + gadget
+ future; freelancer saving for studies; student just exploring) with expected buckets and
notes.
- Content: Flesch >= 50 and <= 20 words per sentence on lessons and definitions; every lesson
has 3–5 slides and one correct answer; every jargon term used has an entry.
- Accessibility and performance: contrast >= 4.5:1 for every text token on every surface in both
themes; tap targets >= 44 px in CSS; icon buttons have aria-labels; file < 300 KB; no network
calls except Google Fonts; Monte Carlo percentiles ordered and chance of loss falling with time.
```

The fix-loop prompt, used after every run:

```
Here are the failing evals with their output: <paste>. Fix the root cause in the app, not the
test. Don't change passing behaviour. Re-run and show the new results.
```

Prompting techniques used

- **Spec before code.** Prompt 1 pins the user, principles, scope and acceptance criteria, so feature prompts can't drift.
- **Numbers over adjectives.** Plan rules, return assumptions and thresholds are explicit, which makes every one of them testable.
- **Negative instructions.** Banned phrases and banned visual clichés stop the model's default fintech output.
- **One layer per prompt.** Each prompt adds one capability to an app that already works, keeping changes small and bugs easy to trace.
- **Evals written from the spec.** The acceptance criteria in Prompt 1 became the checks in Prompt 9.
- **A fixed fix-loop prompt.** Failing output is pasted verbatim, and only root-cause fixes are allowed.